

Dracula

Bram Stoker

1897

The following is an extract from Dracula. Jonathan Harker (the protagonist, narrator and scared, trapped prisoner at Dracula's castle) has gathered the courage to explore the castle in the hope of discovering more about Dracula. He finds a door, which takes him (and the reader) on an eerie walk towards the unknown – but is it (also) eerie because it takes us closer to Freud's repressed uncanny home?

“ *It was open, and led through a stone passage to a circular stairway, which went steeply down.*

I descended, minding carefully where I went for the stairs were dark, being only lit by loopholes in the heavy masonry. At the bottom there was a dark, tunnel-like passage, through which came a deathly, sickly odour, the odour of old earth newly turned. As I went through the passage the smell grew closer and heavier. ¹

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¹ Bram Stoker: Dracula. Grosset & Dunlap, 1897. Project Gutenberg, 2013. Ebook 345.